VOL. 66 EDITION 9 · SEPTEMBER 2023

LVNA Villager

REPRESENTING 1614 HOUSEHOLDS

WELCOME TO THE NEWSLETTER OF THE LAKEWOOD VILLAGE NEIGHBORHOOD ASSOCIATION

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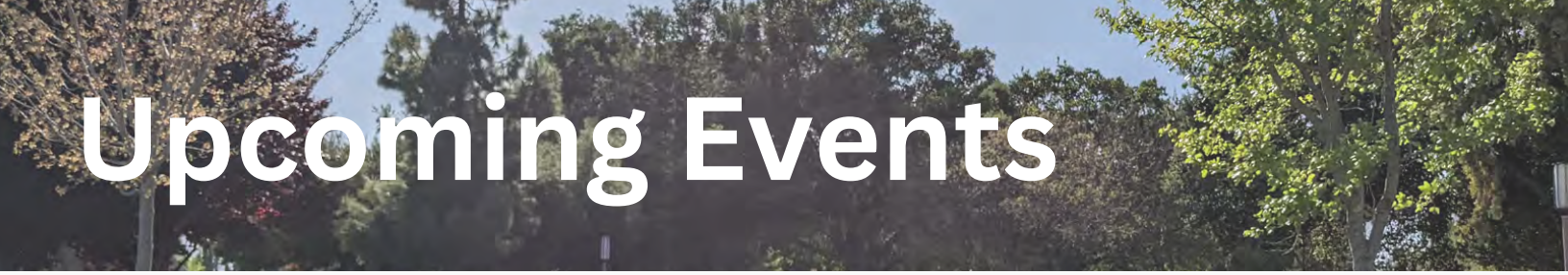
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PHOTO COURTESY OF GAUDENCIA HERRARA



Upcoming Events

Calabazas Creek Clean Up - Sept 23 (tentative date)

Earlier this year as part of the Santa Clara Valley Water District's Adopt-a-Creek program, our neighborhood officially adopted the section of Calabazas Creek that stretches from Wildwood Ave to Tasman Ave. By adopting the creek, the community has made a long-term commitment to protect and nurture it for years to come. With the support of volunteers in our neighborhood, we are responsible for the cleanliness and well-being of the creek, benefiting both the environment and the residents who enjoy its beauty.

Our next clean-up is tentatively scheduled for September 23 from 9:00am - 12:00pm. Join us in clearing debris, collecting litter, and restoring the habitat. Meet at the bridge that goes over the aqueduct (near the intersection of Manzano Way and Oak Creek Way). Contact board@lvnasv.org for more information and to RSVP. An RSVP is not required, but it will help make sure we have enough supplies. Additionally, as this date is tentative, please email board@lvnasv.org or check the LVNA group on Nextdoor to confirm the date and time before attending.

LVNA General Meeting - October 11

Our next quarterly neighborhood association meeting is Wednesday, Oct 11 from 7:00-8:00pm at the Lakewood Park Building. Join your LVNA board members and others for a neighborhood “meet and greet”. No need to RSVP. If you have questions, please email board@lvnasv.org

Monthly Parks and Recreation Commission Meeting - Sept 13

The Parks and Recreation Commission’s monthly meeting will be held in the Bay Conference Room at City Hall (465 W Olive Ave). This is the chance to attend and voice your opinion about the plans for the upcoming Lakewood Park renovation, including your opinion on if the city should use grass or artificial turf in the athletic fields (see article in this Villager). Renovation work is planned to begin in Summer 2024.



Upcoming Events

State of the City Address - Sept 23 (9:00am-1:00pm)

Mayor Larry Klein will deliver the annual State of the City address at City Hall (465 W Olive Ave). Board and Commission members who have served their terms will be recognized, and they will announce the winners of the Sunnyvale Community Awards, which are given to people and organizations that help make Sunnyvale special. More information is on the Sunnyvale website.

Family Harvest Food Giveaway Program - Sept 27 (4:15-5:15pm)

Everyone is eligible to receive additional food through this free food distribution program. All are welcome and you can register on site. The event is held on the fourth Wednesday of each month at the Columbia Middle School Parking Lot (739 Morse Ave). For more information, call the city at 408-730-7800.

Fall StoryWalk - Nov 1 (4:00-6:00pm)

The City is hosting our very own Fall StoryWalk to celebrate Dia de Los Muertos. It will include a featured book, festive arts and crafts, and will be held in Lakewood Park. For more information, call the city at 408-730-7800.

Fall Activities Guide

The City's Fall Activities guide came out in August. Check it out for a list of camps, activities, and more for people of all ages. A digital version of the guide can be found on the Sunnyvale website. Paper copies will be mailed out eventually and can also be found at the Columbia Neighborhood Center (call ahead 408-730-7800 to confirm availability)

Summer Horizon Newsletter

In case you missed it, the City released their periodic newsletter, Horizon. Copies were mailed to all residents, but if you already recycled your copy, the Horizon newsletter is also available online here.



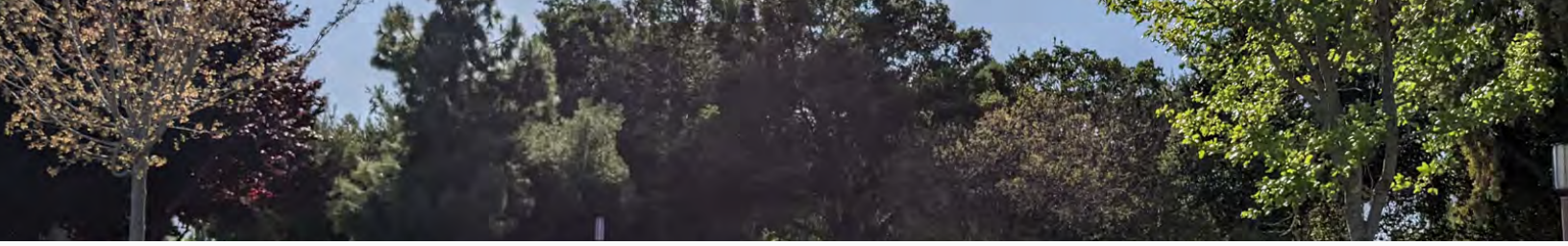
Planned Synthetic Turf in Lakewood Park

As part of the upcoming Lakewood Park renovation, the City of Sunnyvale is planning to install artificial (synthetic) turf in the athletic fields, similar to the turf that is in the new Fair Oaks Park. During the most recent community meeting on the Lakewood Park renovation (July 26), residents raised questions regarding natural grass vs synthetic turf. This article will provide a high-level comparison of the two options, links to additional information, and steps to share your opinion with the City and the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Natural grass is, obviously, a field made of natural grass. It requires watering and fertilization, but it's good for our health, cleans our air, connects us to nature, and is durable. Synthetic turf is made of plastic, petroleum and other chemicals. Many synthetic turfs contain PFAS chemicals, "forever chemicals" that are toxic and never break down. Synthetic turf is not regulated by any US government entity. In 2015, the Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) withdrew its finding that synthetic turf is safe to play on; the new CPSC findings only indicate that their research was insufficient to determine if synthetic turf is or is not safe to play on. After playing on a synthetic field, the CDC recommends not eating while on the field, washing skin with soap and water, and removing clothes that were worn on the field.

Here is a quick comparison of natural grass vs synthetic (artificial/fake) turf:

Topic	Natural Grass	Synthetic Turf
Injuries	While injuries happen on natural grass, the frequency is lower with natural grass than synthetic turf.	Studies have consistently found that athletes are more likely to get injured playing on a synthetic turf. One study found risk of injury increased by 58% on artificial turf, with especially high injury rates in football, soccer, and rugby. Football players may also be at risk of increased ACL injuries on synthetic turf.
Water	Requires regular watering	Substantial amounts of water is used to make the turf. Additionally, on hot days, the turf has to be watered regular to keep it cool.
Weatherproofing	Not weatherproof; fields often close after rain	While sometimes called "weatherproof", artificial turf has poor water runoff after rain (and often bits of the turf wash away with the water).
Maintenance	Regular mowing, water, and other lawn care	Regulars regular maintenance and cleaning. Tasks include surface brushing, surface raking and sweeping, turf infill redistribution and refill, and impact tests. Failure to perform regular maintenance can void warranties. Artificial sports fields should be cleaned weekly and require monthly deep cleaning.
Heat	Naturally dissipates heat, helping to cool the environment	Turf temperature can reach 120-180 degrees F, resulting in melted shoes, blistered hands and feet, dehydration, and/or heatstroke. Artificial turf also contributes to the Heat Island Effect, which increases the temperature of the area surrounding the turf.
Restrictions on Use	None	Many. For example, while the artificial fields at Fair Oaks are called "multi-use" because they are striped for soccer and baseball, their use is actually highly restricted. The field is fenced off and restrictions include no dogs, no food, no chairs, and no volleyball. See photo for full list of restrictions.
Disposal costs	N/A	High. It must be replaced every 8-10 years. Additionally, many landfills do not accept turf, making disposal of synthetic turf difficult. There are also environmental costs related to disposal, since many of the chemicals in artificial turf never breakdown.
Lead exposure	None	Yes. The CDC has identified artificial turf as one of seven primary sources of lead exposure in youth.
Environmental benefits	Lots. Connects us to nature, absorbs carbon dioxide, and provides a place for wildlife	None. Under high temperatures and sunlight, synthetic turf releases dust, which contains carcinogens and other toxic chemicals



Synthetic Turf (Cont.)

In short, the trade off between synthetic turf and natural grass comes down to convenience vs health. Synthetic turf is convenient while it lasts (albeit expensive to install, maintain, and replace), but bad for our health and our environment. Natural grass requires more maintenance, but it's better for our health and our environment. To learn more, check out these links:

- The Problem With Artificial Turf
- Heat Levels on Artificial Turf
- Sports field management
- Artificial Turf Versus Natural Grass
- Are Synthetic Playing Surfaces Doing More Harm Than Good?
- Costs: Grass vs Synthetic Turf
- Artificial Turf Field Maintenance Costs and Guidelines
- Potential Exposure to Lead in Artificial Turf
- PFAS: The 'Forever Chemicals' You Couldn't Escape if You Tried
- 'Forever Chemicals' Are Everywhere. What Are They Doing to Us?
- Santa Clara County Medical Association letter to Los Gatos-Saratoga Union High School District "Recommendation to replace artificial turf with natural turf for Saratoga High School
- CPSC no longer stands by safety of artificial turf

Ways to make your voice heard

- In favor of natural grass and pushing the City to ban synthetic turf? Sign this petition
- Attend the September meeting of the Parks and Recreation Commission. It will be a hybrid meeting on Wednesday, Sept 13 at 7:00pm in the Bay Conference Room at City Hall (465 W Olive Ave). The Zoom link is here.
- Email the members of the Parks and Recreation Commission at parksandrecreationcommission@sunnyvale.ca.gov
- Call Damon Sparacino, Superintendent of Community Services, at 408-730-7342
- Speak at an upcoming City Council meeting. The City Council meets Tuesday Sept 12 and Tues Sept 26 at 7:00pm both online and in-person (Bay Conference Room, City Hall, 456 W Olive Ave). The Zoom link is here.
- Email Mayor Larry Klein at kleincouncil@sunnyvale.ca.gov and Councilmember Omar Din dincouncil@sunnyvale.ca.gov
- Want to do more? Email vp1@lvnasv.org to be connected to a group of Sunnyvale residents advocating against the synthetic turf

Here's a link to all upcoming City meetings: https://www.sunnyvale.ca.gov/your-government/governance/city-council/meetings-and-agendas/-curm-9/-cury-2023

Transportation Updates from SEE (Sunnyvale for Equity in Education)

By Peggy Brewster & Lauren Ledbetter, SunnyvaleEquityInEducation@gmail.com, https://bit.ly/joinSEE

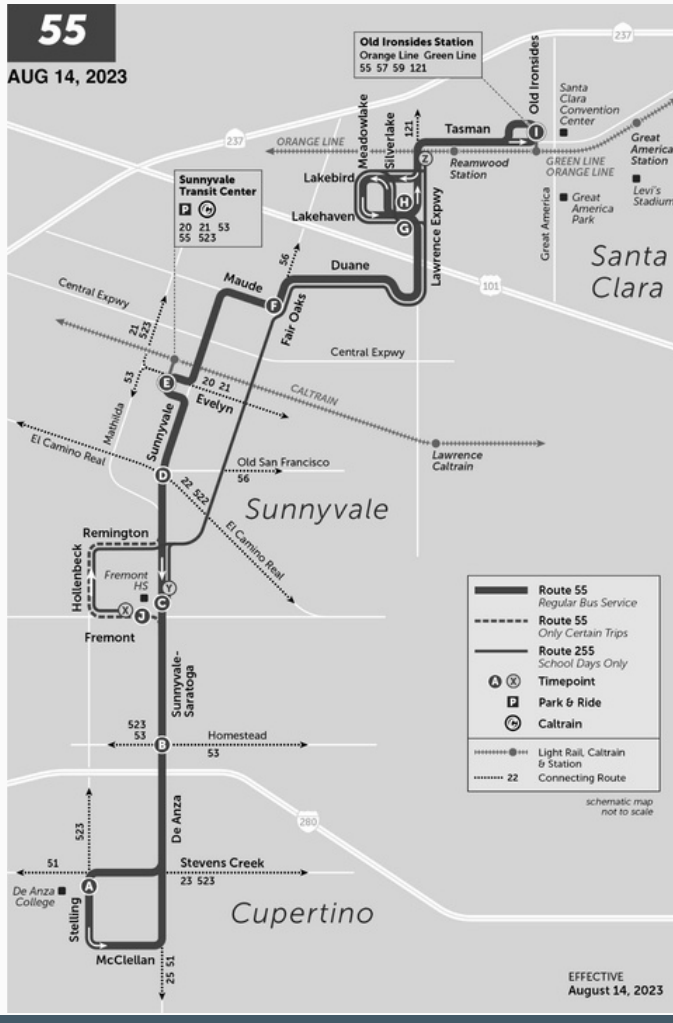
It has been a busy month, as kids return to school and the district begins the process to move to trustee area elections. Here are some quick updates about transportation to Fremont High School (FHS) for North Sunnyvale high school students, and the upcoming Fremont Union High School District (FUHSD) redistricting effort.

Transportation Update

There were two substantial changes in FHS transportation for students. First, ALL students north of El Camino Real are eligible for FREE bus passes, regardless of income! Go to http://bitly.ws/RFWA to start the application.
Second, VTA has added a new Limited Stop 255 bus route from Lakewood to Fremont High. See the map showing the new 255 service route. Check schedules at https://www.vta.org/go/routes or call VTA Customer Service at 408-321-2300.

District Elections

Currently, Trustees for the FUHSD are elected district wide, and all current trustees live south of El Camino Real. For the fall 2024 election, FUHSD hopes to move to trustee area elections. To prepare, they are holding a series of required public meetings to discuss how to split the district into trustee areas. The decisions made over the next several months will impact families for years to come. SEE is following the process closely and actively participating.
On August 22, the Fremont Union High School District held the first pre-map public hearing to discuss the process of moving from district wide to trustee-area elections.
On September 19th at 6:15pm (in person and online), FUHSD will hold the second pre-map public hearing and presentation. Consultants will present about considerations in drawing school board maps, and there will be opportunities for public comment. Go to https://www.fuhsd.org/newsroom/trustee-areas for more information. SEE members will be in attendance - please reach out to us if you are able to join and provide public comment.





Use Access Sunnyvale for Service Requests/Complaints

In the July general meeting, Mayor Klein emphasized that residents should use the City of Sunnyvale's online portal Access Sunnyvale (https://sunnyvale.dynamics365portals.us/) to submit online services requests and report issues. This is faster and gets a quicker response than a phone call. Additionally, when you submit a request via Access Sunnyvale, you get a ticket number. If your ticket is not promptly addressed/resolved, you should contact our Councilmember Omar Din (dincouncil@sunnyvale.ca.gov) or Mayor Klein (larry@larryklein.com) for help (and include your ticket number).

Some of the many things you can use Access Sunnyvale to report are:

- Abandoned vehicles (vehicles parked in the same spot for more than 72 hours)
- Graffiti
- Traffic issues (if the violation is in progress and requires an officer response, you can call 408-730-7181)
- Noise disturbances (including airplane noise)
- Needed park maintenance (e.g., broken toilets, trash cleanup)
- Needed sidewalk repairs
- Tree maintenance

These all have the option to require a response from City Staff and create a paper trail of things that need maintenance or attention. Please help maintain our neighborhood and report things that need the City's attention.

Here are the steps to using Access Sunnyvale:

1. Go to https://sunnyvale.dynamics365portals.us/
2. Choose the topic area for your service request (you can either search for a topic or select from several icons).
3. Enter the information for your service request. The more detail you can provide, the better and easier it is for the City to respond.
4. Be sure to select "yes" for "Response from City Staff Requested?". This guarantees you will get a staff member to reply to your request.
5. Choose "Submit" at the bottom. You will get an email with your ticket number and follow up information will be sent to your email address.

Event Recaps

RECAP - COMMUNITY MEETING #3 ON LAKEWOOD PARK RENOVATION (from July 26)

The City held the third community meeting to solicit feedback on the planned renovation for Lakewood Park. It was a virtual meeting, and the meeting minutes can be found here. More information on the Lakewood Park renovation can be found here.

RECAP - NATIONAL NIGHT OUT (from Aug 1)

After a hiatus due to covid, LVNA brought back our neighborhood's annual National Night Out (NNO) party on August 1 at Lakewood Park. LVNA provided the ice cream for sundaes. The Sunnyvale Department of Public Safety brought a fire truck for kids (and adults) to explore. SERV (Sunnyvale Emergency Response Volunteers) set up a table to provide additional information about emergency preparedness. City Councilmember (and Vice Mayor) Omar Din, Sunnyvale School District board member Eileen Le, and Supervisor Otto Lee all came by to introduce themselves and meet members of our community. It was a great chance to meet new people, and we are looking forward to NNO 2024!





Support Our Neighbors

B KOHL CONSTRUCTION

Owner BRUCE KOHL

LIC. # 978991

B-General Building
Sunnyvale, CA 94089
(408) 940-2487
B j kohl@outlook.com



ExpressOffers

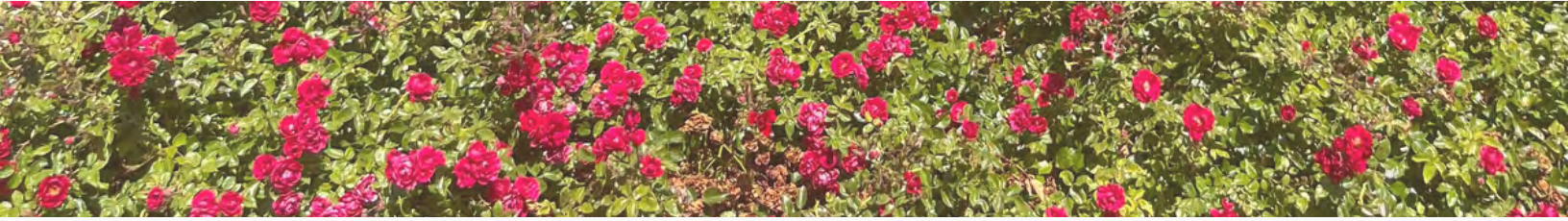
Jimmy Kang
Lic. 01113615
408-888-7742
jimmy.kang@exprealty.com
jimmykang.exprealty.com

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RECAP - WALK WITH THE MAYOR (from July 29)

On Saturday morning (the same Saturday as Dumpster Day), the Mayor of Sunnyvale, Larry Klein, joined us for a walk around our neighborhood. He was very gracious, and we spoke with neighbors who monitored or filled the dumpsters as well as many people we met along the sidewalks. Neighbors raised concerns about the condition of the sidewalks, the overgrown trees blocking city lights, and the general condition of Lakewood Village. Mr. Klein is genuinely concerned for Lakewood and will be actively trying to address our complaints. His answer for sidewalks lights and overgrown trees is that the City of Sunnyvale will immediately address issues of safety. All of us need to be vigilant about either continually calling the city or using the Access Sunnyvale website to report issues we have with our neighborhood (see article in this Villager on how to use Access Sunnyvale). We also discussed Calabasas Creek and Sunnyvale's involvement with its maintenance. Mayor Klein indicates he will continue to try to help us with the creek cleanup, and he plans to do one of his runs down Calabasas Trail to get a firsthand view of our concerns.

RECAP - DUMPSTER DAY (from July 29)

The annual LVNA Dumpster Day was a huge success! We collected 98.85 tons of garbage across 20 dumpsters (including 2 for tree trimmings and 2 for mattresses/carpeting) in the Lakewood and Fairwood neighborhoods. The Goodwill truck was also a success. Goodwill paid LVNA fifteen cents for each pound of items donated. Thanks to the stuff that everyone donated, LVNA will be getting a check for $1001 from Goodwill to support our programs, Villager printing, and neighborhood events. A huge shout out to Bev Woidyla for coordinating the event - and making sandwiches for all of our dumpster monitors. A massive THANK YOU to all of the people who volunteered to make this event a success, especially everyone who agreed to be a dumpster monitor!

Little Free Puzzle Library

A quick reminder that the Lakewood/Fairwood villages have their own Little Free Puzzle Library. Please come by to take a few puzzles or drop some off. As a gentle reminder, this is a resource for the entire community. Please take no more than 3 puzzles at a time. While it's not required to return the puzzles when you are done, returning them will help keep the Puzzle Library well stocked. For location information, please email vp1@lvnasv.org





Neighborhood Scavenger Hunt

Welcome to the September Scavenger Hunt! It's been a few months since our last one. Send your name, address (to confirm that you live in the Lakewood/Fairwood neighborhood), and answers to the three questions to vp1@lvnasv.org by September 25, and we will announce the winner and the correct answers in the next newsletter. If there is a tie for the winner, we will randomly select one person as the winner. The winner will get to choose a $10 gift card from World Wrapps, Wal-Mart, or Giovanni's Pizzeria.

1. What is the name of the greenbelt that runs through the Lakewood and Fairwood neighborhoods?
   a. Jon W. Christon Greenbelt
   b. John W. Christian Greenbelt
   c. John E. Christian Greenbelt
   d. John W. Kristen Greenbelt
2. Who is the manufacturer of the picnic tables that are near the playground area of Lakewood Park?
   a. Pilot Rock
   b. Chimney Rock
   c. Bay Rock
   d. Mountain Rock
3. Which of the following is NOT an exercise included in the Vita Course set-up in the Fairwood neighborhood?
   a. Log jump
   b. Parallel bars
   c. Pull up
   d. Lunges

Answers from the August scavenger hunt:

1. *True or False: At the intersection of Silverlake Dr and Lakebird Dr, the fire hydrant is at the southwest corner. ANSWER: (b) False*
2. *What is the Fairwood Elementary School mascot? ANSWER: (d) Falcons*
3. *There's a mural at Lakewood Park near the basketball courts. Which of these is NOT included on the mural? ANSWER: (d) All of the above)*







Kids Corner

By Ancella Simoes

Origami Butterfly



Follow along this tutorial video to make your own pretty butterfly and decorate your garden or home.
Tutorial: https://youtu.be/mfI3MIbbkgM

Textured Fall Leaves



This is an interesting tutorial which encourages kids to observe nature in the form of different types of leaves, patterns and textures. Take a look and follow along to create your own imaginative art pieces.
Tutorial: https://youtu.be/-P1-iutx4nI

California Park Spotlight: Pismo State Beach

With fall season around the corner, this state beach becomes a popular destination for those who want to see pretty monarch butterflies. The spot falls on the route to their migration destination, seeking shelter from the northern winter. From late October to February, these majestic butterflies cluster on the limbs of towering eucalyptus trees which are present in large numbers in this area. This is a 3 hour road trip from Sunnyvale, more information can be found on this site.
For more information on Monarch Butterfly facts, migration patterns, threats they face as well as how planting native milkweeds help the populations grow, visit this link.



Bringing Back Printed Villagers

To help improve communication within our community, the LVNA is changing our newsletter structure. For each quarter, we will do one printed Villager and two electronic (email) Villagers. To provide this service to the neighborhood, we need help with two things:

- Delivery people: We need more people ("walkers") to help deliver the printed Villagers to houses. Each route has about 40-60 houses, and we need walkers on both the Fairwood and Lakewood side. This is a good opportunity to be outside, get exercise, and meet your neighbors! You'll get at least 1 week of notice before we need you, and we're hoping to have enough volunteers to have back-ups to cover when someone goes on vacation. The time commitment is 1-2 hours once every three months. Please email board@lvnasv.org if you can help.
- Ads: It costs money to print the Villagers. To generate revenue to offset the costs of printing the Villager, we are returning to a paid ad service for printed Villagers. Do you have a small business that you want to advertise? Prices start at $35 per printed Villager for a business-card sized ad. As a bonus, if you pay for at least 4 ads (a one-year subscription), we will include your ad for free in our electronic (email) Villagers (8 per year). Please email ads@lvnasv.org if interested.

Your ad can go here!

Please email vp1@lvnasv.org for more information





LVNA Resources

EST 1958

LVNA Contacts

President: Rick Flovin	president@lvnasv.org
1st Vice President: Cortney Jansen	vp1@lvnasv.org
2nd Vice President: Tony Bugna	vp2@lvnasv.org
Treasurer: Linh Ly	treasurer@lvnasv.org
Secretary: Christy Majchrowicz	secretary@lvnasv.org
LVNA Layout Editor: Nathan Chan	editor@lvnasv.org
LVNA Content Editor: Cortney Jansen	vp1@lvnasv.org

Find us on Nextdoor!

If you have not already joined the LVNA group on Nextdoor then we encourage you to do so. Nextdoor allows separate settings for group posts so it's an excellent way to get curated Lakewood Village-relevant content while filtering out the rest. Board members post reminders about upcoming events and moderators ensure all activity in the group adheres to the group's rules (e.g., content relevant to Lakewood Village, no soliciting, etc.). Note that only Lakewood Village residents are permitted to join. To learn more or to join, visit nextdoor.com/g/alya6yxap

Wanted - Help with the Villager

LVNA is for additional support to keep the Villager going. We need a new Villager Editor and an additional Villager Content Creator/Writer. Both positions are open to anyone who is interested (no age requirement). With input from the LVNA Board, the Villager Editor plans content for each newsletter and edits it. The Villager Content Creator/Writer role consists of writing articles for the Villager. Articles can be contributed monthly or quarterly. The roles could also be combined into a single position if there is interest to do so.

Any of these roles are a great opportunity to help actively drive change for our community and make a positive impact on our neighborhood. If interested, please email the board at board@lvnasv.org and let them know you're on board (yes, pun fully intended).

Email vp1@lvnasv.org to include an advertisement for your business or to submit your photography from around the neighborhood to be featured in the Villager.

Important Numbers

Emergency
911

Abandoned Vehicles
(408) 730-7150

Shopping Carts & Graffiti
(408) 730-7680

Animal Control
(408) 730-7178

Neighborhood Preservation
(408) 730-7610

Parks & Maintenance
(408) 730-7506

Public Safety - Info
(408) 730-7100

Public Safety - Non-Emergency
(408) 730-7180

City Jobs
(408) 730-4790

Sewer/Water/Utilities
(408) 730-4700

Street Lights/Sidewalks
(408) 730-7415

Street Trees/Parks
(408) 730-7505